ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 12: **The Midnight Visitor (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** falls while trying to use an escape route that does not exist	A trickster is tricked.
2	**(c)** a tight single scene building to a twist	Compact plot.
3	**(c)** implicit disapproval; wit solves the problem	Wit preferred.
4	**(d)** the reader has met Ausable's wit earlier	Characterisation prepares us.
5	**(c)** foreshadowing of the fatal fall	Height prepares the danger.
6	**(c)** Ausable must have thought quickly because he had danger before	Reading between the lines.
7	**(a)** suspenseful with underlying humour	Danger plus light touch.
8	**(c)** If there had been a balcony, Max would not have fallen.	Past unreal condition.
9	**(a)** believing the lie	Participle phrase modifies Max.
10	**(a)** Max, who relies on force	Max's force contrasts with his wit.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Max was an armed intruder threatening life (1) so deceiving him was self-defence rather than a moral fault (1).	1+1
12	Fear makes people irrational (1) and a calm mind can exploit another's fear (1).	1+1
13	He threatens life and breaks in (1) but he is also a professional doing a job and is destroyed by his own fear (1).	1+1
14	Fowler expects glamour (1) but finds a plain man whose strength is intellect, showing the reality is less showy (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The title promises a night visitor and mystery. The first lines show Fowler's curiosity and Ausable's ordinary look. These set up the contrast and make Max's entrance a strong shock.	1+1+1
16	He begins as a naive observer and ends as a wiser young man. His journey from expectation to understanding gives structure to the plot. It also conveys the theme.	1+1+1
17	Ausable seems an ordinary, heavy man but is a genius of improvisation. Even the 'balcony' is an appearance made by words. The theme works on character and plot.	1+1+1
	OR: The twist is built from details placed earlier, such as the height of the window. It gives a sharp climax and a clear moral. It is effective but depends on Max's quick belief.	1+1+1
18	Midnight and a high hotel room isolate the characters. No help can come. The closed time and place make the duel of wits more intense.	1+1+1
	OR: A single hotel room creates unity and tension. It acts like a stage for a duel. The reader's attention stays on the minds of the characters.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Thesis (1). Max's gun and force (1). Ausable's wit and trick (1). Role of fear and haste (1). Evaluation of the message (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Editor's questions (1). Fowler describes the plot (1). Discussion of the title (1). Agreement (1).	2+2+1
20	Setup: Fowler's visit (1). Complication: Max's entry (1). Climax: the knock and the jump (1). Resolution: Ausable's explanation (1). Effect of the compact plot (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Statement (1). Self-defence argument (1). Danger of lying as habit (1). Context matters (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Ausable a tall, handsome secret agent; he is a **fat, ordinary-looking** man, unlike the spies Fowler imagined from books.
- Writing that the visitor Max came through the front door; he is a spy who enters the room **unseen at midnight**, and holds Ausable and Fowler at gunpoint.
- Mixing up the trick: Ausable bluffs that police are at the door, and Max jumps through the window to a 'balcony' that **does not exist**.
- Calling Fowler the hero; he is a young writer of *romantic spy tales* who learns that real adventure is different.
- Forgetting that the 'police' were only a **waiter** with a drink, which Ausable had expected from **Henry**.
- Spelling slips: *Ausable, Fowler, espionage, balcony, thriller*; and mixed tenses when summarising the plot.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 12: **The Midnight Visitor (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** an ordinary-looking spy who stays cheerful in danger	Light touches.
2	**(a)** do not trust unverified claims under pressure	Max's error.
3	**(d)** popular romantic ideas about adventure	A stereotype corrected.
4	**(a)** Cleverness, not violence, wins in crisis	Moral.
5	**(a)** Was Ausable justified in deceiving Max?	Opens ethical debate.
6	**(c)** It was a morally defensible act of self-defence	He saved himself and his papers.
7	**(d)** that a balcony exists below the window	He trusted the lie.
8	**(c)** restores calm after the climax	Resolution.
9	**(c)** he hid his thoughts under a calm expression	Idiom for hidden feelings.
10	**(b)** quick at finding ways out of difficulty	Resourceful.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He treats a deadly situation lightly (1) and the calm tone makes the danger and his courage stand out (1).	1+1
12	Narration is through Fowler (1) so the trick must remain hidden until the climax (1).	1+1
13	It matches Max's desire to escape (1) and the high, panicked moment leaves him no time to check (1).	1+1
14	We sense Ausable's confidence but do not know the plan (1) and share Fowler's wonder when it works (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Max has power: a gun and surprise. Ausable has intelligence. The story shows that power is useless against a clever plan. Intelligence turns the situation upside down.	1+1+1
16	Use close shots of Max's panicking face and the knock. Light the window as an escape. Cut to the empty window after the jump. Silence increases the effect.	1+1+1
17	Humour in Ausable's tone lightens fear. It also shows his calm confidence. This mix of tension and humour entertains the reader.	1+1+1
	OR: The reader gradually realises that no balcony exists while Max believes it. This gap in knowledge makes the climax tense. It also gives the pleasure of seeing the trickster tricked.	1+1+1
18	Only three characters appear, each with a clear role. This keeps the plot tight and the tension high. It also focuses the theme on wit versus force.	1+1+1
	OR: It teaches to keep calm and think in danger. It warns that violence does not pay. It also urges us to value brains and judge people by action.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Fowler's innocence (1). Limited knowledge increases suspense (1). His reactions guide the reader (1). It makes the twist striking (1). Evaluation of the choice (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The high floor (1). Ausable's calm (1). The window mention (1). The knock (1). Together they make the ending logical (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Ausable's appearance and reality (1). Personal example (1). Reasons for deception (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Clear opening (1). Rising tension (1). The clever plan (1). Climax (1). Resolution (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Ausable a tall, handsome secret agent; he is a **fat, ordinary-looking** man, unlike the spies Fowler imagined from books.

- Writing that the visitor Max came through the front door; he is a spy who enters the room **unseen at midnight**, and holds Ausable and Fowler at gunpoint.
- Mixing up the trick: Ausable bluffs that police are at the door, and Max jumps through the window to a 'balcony' that **does not exist**.
- Calling Fowler the hero; he is a young writer of *romantic spy tales* who learns that real adventure is different.
- Forgetting that the 'police' were only a **waiter** with a drink, which Ausable had expected from **Henry**.
- Spelling slips: *Ausable, Fowler, espionage, balcony, thriller*; and mixed tenses when summarising the plot.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 12: **The Midnight Visitor (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** admired through Fowler's eyes	Fowler's narration shapes admiration.
2	**(b)** appearance versus ability	Ausable looks ordinary but is brilliant.
3	**(c)** Max's belief in the lie is rather convenient	A plausible critical remark.
4	**(d)** an extended description of nature	No nature descriptions.
5	**(d)** he would have been hurt or the papers lost	He was unarmed.
6	**(b)** tight scene, tense dialogue, sudden climax	Visual drama.
7	**(b)** figurative	Not a literal disarming.
8	**(c)** make the twist more astonishing	Innocent viewpoint.
9	**(d)** Ausable uses a trick against a trickster	He outwits a professional.
10	**(b)** we would see the fear and greed but lose the surprise	The twist would vanish.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A closed hotel room cuts off escape (1) and focuses attention on the duel of minds (1).	1+1
12	It begins slowly with Fowler's visit (1) and accelerates sharply with Max's entry and the climax (1).	1+1
13	He validates the story (1) and his reaction guides our moral and emotional response (1).	1+1
14	The twist resolves the danger (1) and justice is served through the villain's own error (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The stereotype is slim, daring and armed. Ausable is plump and unarmed yet wins through wit. The comparison makes the story fresh and realistic.	1+1+1
16	Because Max believed the lie, he jumped. The subordinate clause gives the reason for the action.	1+1+1
17	We learn about Ausable from his calm talk and trick, Max from his gun and panic, and Fowler from his questions. The writer lets the deeds speak.	1+1+1
	OR: The story shows deceit used in self-defence against an armed intruder. It does not make lying a general virtue. Its real focus is quick thinking.	1+1+1
18	Ausable said to Max, 'There is a balcony outside the window.' The tense and pronouns revert to the speaker's original.	1+1+1
	OR: He would claim to have been tricked and robbed of the papers. He would be angry at the lie but would admit he panicked. The statement would show his shame.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Max: physical and weapon strength (1). Ausable: mental strength (1). Their actions in the crisis (1). Outcome (1). What the writer values (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Danger: gun, midnight (1). Humour: Ausable's calm style (1). Contrast eases tension (1). It also increases admiration (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Define suspense (1). Use of setting and time (1). Delay of the reveal (1). Dialogue and twist (1). Overall judgement (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Title and author (1). Short plot summary (1). Strengths (1). Weaknesses (1). Recommendation (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Ausable a tall, handsome secret agent; he is a **fat, ordinary-looking** man, unlike the spies Fowler imagined from books.
- Writing that the visitor Max came through the front door; he is a spy who enters the room **unseen at midnight**, and holds Ausable and Fowler at gunpoint.
- Mixing up the trick: Ausable bluffs that police are at the door, and Max jumps through the window to a 'balcony' that **does not exist**.

- Calling Fowler the hero; he is a young writer of *romantic spy tales* who learns that real adventure is different.
- Forgetting that the 'police' were only a **waiter** with a drink, which Ausable had expected from **Henry**.
- Spelling slips: *Ausable, Fowler, espionage, balcony, thriller*; and mixed tenses when summarising the plot.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND